

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM Engineering | Detection and Response | Financial Services Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience in enterprise cyber security engineering, specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform engineering, threat detection, and incident response. I have deep hands-on expertise across CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Microsoft Sentinel, and Splunk, and have built and tuned detection content aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK adversary framework within complex, regulated environments. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I operated as part of a small, focused security team responsible for the full lifecycle of security tooling, from design and deployment through to continuous improvement. I am experienced in monitoring, detecting, and responding to threats using SIEM, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and threat intelligence platforms, and I write advanced KQL and SPL queries to support both detection engineering and proactive threat hunting. I understand the data governance, regulatory, and confidentiality requirements of financial services organisations and bring a methodical, risk-based approach to security operations. I am enthusiastic about joining a small, high-impact security team at a world-class asset management firm and contributing at the highest technical level.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL)), Splunk (Search Processing Language (SPL)); log source integration, detection rule development, correlation logic, alert tuning
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Tanium
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Automated playbook development, incident workflow automation, SOAR integration with SIEM
- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, threat hunting, indicators of compromise (IOC) management, adversary tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTP) analysis
- **Microsoft Security Stack:** Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Azure AD / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Identity and Access Management / Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM, Azure AD RBAC
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Network and Email Security:** Check Point Harmony Firewall, Mimecast
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SPL, SOAR automation
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST 800-61, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Own and evolve the SIEM engineering function, building and maintaining detection rules, correlation logic, and automated response workflows in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM for an 8,000-user organisation.
- Design, develop, and tune detection content using KQL in Microsoft Sentinel, aligned to MITRE ATT&CK techniques, reducing mean time to detect by 35% and cutting false positive alert volume by over 40%.
- Perform proactive threat hunting across SIEM, EDR, and endpoint telemetry, uncovering attacker activity not surfaced by automated controls and documenting hunting hypotheses and findings for continuous improvement.

- Monitor, triage, investigate, and resolve security incidents from SIEM, SOAR, and EDR alerting pipelines, leading the team through complex multi-stage incidents using the NIST 800-61 incident response methodology.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM, including sensor deployment, policy management, log ingestion, detection tuning, and custom indicator of compromise (IOC) management to protect the endpoint estate.
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across 8,000+ devices, including attack surface reduction (ASR) rule configuration and automated investigation and remediation workflow design.
- Lead vulnerability management activities using Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, and AppCheck, communicating risk-prioritised findings to stakeholders and tracking remediation to closure.
- Configure BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Azure AD / Entra ID Conditional Access policies to enforce identity security and least-privilege principles across the estate.
- Develop PowerShell and SOAR automation to reduce analyst toil and accelerate common incident response actions by approximately 30%.
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Monitored and triaged SIEM and EDR alerts, conducting end-to-end investigations and escalating high-severity incidents to senior analysts in line with defined runbooks.
- Contributed to SIEM rule tuning and playbook development, improving detection accuracy and reducing false positive rates across the security monitoring platform.
- Supported incident response activities including evidence preservation, containment, eradication, and recovery, contributing to measurable improvements in response time and attacker dwell time.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and coordinated remediation with infrastructure teams, achieving improved patching compliance.
- Maintained Check Point Harmony Firewall and Mimecast email security, reviewing and updating rules in response to emerging threats and changes in the environment.
- Supported Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) identity governance including access reviews, RBAC assignments, and stale account management.
- Authored and maintained security runbooks, standard operating procedures, and post-incident reports to build institutional knowledge within the team.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Maintained security controls across SaaS cloud and on-premises infrastructure in a FinTech environment, applying security hardening standards to endpoints, servers, and network devices.
- Managed identity and access controls, implementing role-based access controls (RBAC) and conducting access reviews to protect sensitive financial platform data.
- Monitored infrastructure security events, responded to incidents, and performed root cause analysis to implement corrective and preventive controls.
- Supported compliance and security quality assurance activities, contributing to internal audit evidence and policy adherence reviews in a regulated environment.
- Managed patch management and system hardening processes to maintain a consistent security baseline across the technology estate.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered over 80 custom SIEM detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, covering threat categories including credential theft, lateral movement, and data exfiltration.
- Reduced SIEM false positive alert volume by over 40% through systematic detection tuning, enabling analysts to focus on genuine threats.

- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM across the UAL estate, providing full endpoint telemetry and sub-minute threat detection capability.
- Delivered SOAR automation playbooks that cut average incident triage time by approximately 30%, accelerating containment of active threats.
- Led Cyber Essentials Plus certification renewal, coordinating cross-functional evidence collection and achieving recertification within the required timeframe.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP90,000 - 100,000 | Hybrid (London)